large portion of this wide world is different from democracy as understood in the mid-Victorian era. Russia to-day is ruled by a party—not by a parliament elected on the basis of adult suffrage—but that party claims to act on behalf of the people. Similarly in Italy and also in Germany, a party has usurped all political power, having suppressed all political parties, but this party claims to represent the people. In Spain, on the contrary, when the Socialists were in power, they experimented in mid-Victorian democracy. As a magnanimous gesture of good-will, they have the vote to all adult women, without stopping to think what would be the effect to that measure. The enfranchised women gave their votes to the Catholic and Right-wing parties in overwhelming numbers and as a result the Socialists were soon swept out of office. No better example of 'political harakiri' can be found in recent history.

Russia is not the only country where mid-Victorian parliamentary methods had to be done away with. The Fascists in Italy and the Nazis in Germany, as we have already noted, also disenfranchised the opposition parties and ultimately suppressed them in order to consolidate their own power. The political experiments have to be taken note of and studied by us, if we are to avoid pitfalls in future.

I am inclined to think that the Congress Socialist Party contains within itself the promise of a great future. It has been able to draw towards itself the radical elements in Indian National Congress—and if it develops along the right lines and adopts the correct ideology, slogans and shibboleths, it will have an irresistable appeal. If, unfortunately, it does not, and if it falls a victim to the same confusion of ideas which has seized the present day Congress leaders, then the masses will ultimately turn to some other party for their salvation. As the first step towards the clarification of our economico-political ideas, we must give the go-by to the false idea of unity. The experience of the All Parties' Committee and the All Parties' Conference of 1928 should have taught us by now that unity has vale only when it represents not only unity in ideas, but also unity in action. A real unity is a source of infinite strength; superficial unity is only a source of weakness. The Indian Liberals chose to cooperate with the Congress only so long as the Government neglected them—as in the case of the Simon Commission. But as soon as seats were offered them at the